

The launch exposed a manual intake bottleneck

Selected workflow: business analyst support-email intake, from arrival to accepted ownership.

WHAT CHANGED

Support-email volume increased after the recent launch. The analyst still has to interpret each message before the right team can act.

01 More intake

New requests and follow-ups compete for attention in the same intake workflow.

02 More coordination

Reading, classification, priority checks, owner selection and reply drafting remain manual.

03 Later technical action

Until a request reaches an accepted owner, the technical team cannot begin its part of the work.

HOW I BUILT THE CURRENT-STATE MAP

I mapped the original specialist workflow on paper and reviewed 25 supplied tickets to identify request types. Here, I apply that intake pattern to the business analyst's role.

ANALYSIS BOUNDARY

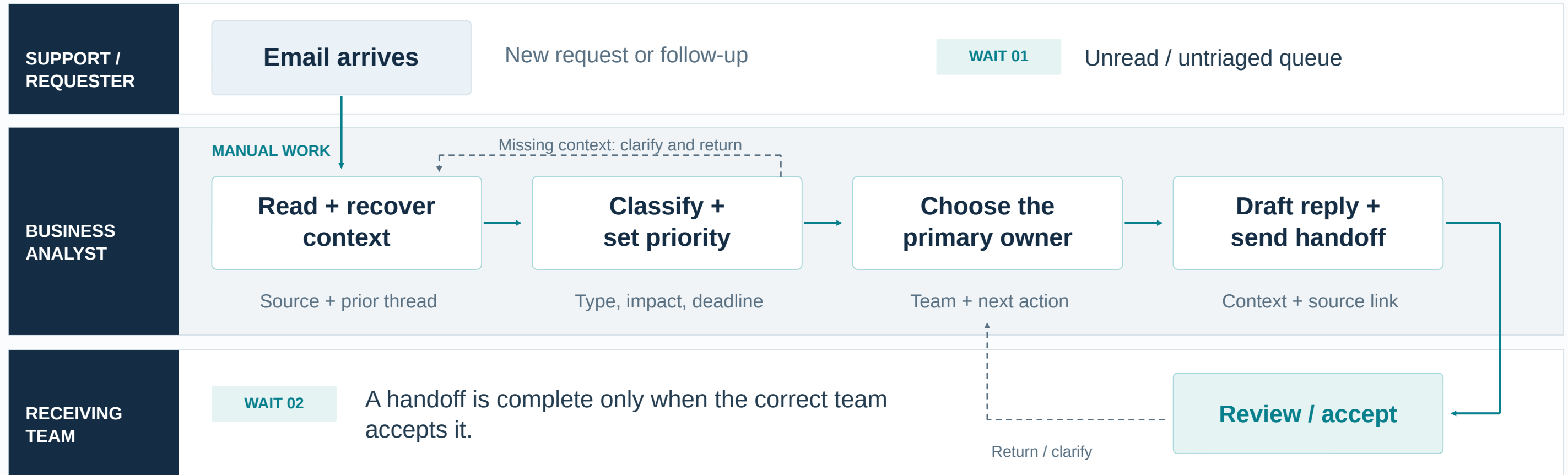
Start: inbound email.

End: reply sent or team ownership accepted.

Technical resolution sits outside this scope.

Every message passes through manual triage

A swimlane view separates analyst work, waiting and the point where the receiving team takes ownership.



ROUTINE REQUEST

Routine replies stay with the analyst for review and sending.

TECHNICAL REQUEST

Accepted ownership ends intake. Investigation and resolution follow.

A label is not enough for a technical handoff

Use the original request families, then confirm the enterprise owner and the information each team needs.

REQUEST FAMILY	ENTERPRISE DESTINATION TO CONFIRM	HANDOFF CHECK
Setup / implementation	Service or implementation owner	Affected service, launch milestone, blocker and requested action.
Invoices / contracts / sales	Operations or commercial owner	Relevant document or reference, responsible party and the actual question.
Technical issue / feature request	Technical support or product owner	Separate a defect from a request. Include impact, evidence and affected service.
P0 / P1, privacy or safety	Designated escalation owner	State the situation and deadline. Do not infer urgency from tone alone.

MULTI-TOPIC EMAIL

Name one coordinator and track each issue so secondary requests are not lost.

AMBIGUOUS FOLLOW-UP

Keep with the analyst until prior context and the next owner are clear.

Request families: [S1]. Enterprise destinations and handoff checks are the working adaptation, not a confirmed ownership model.

The analyst queue can delay the whole delivery chain

The launch increases pressure at intake. These are the handoff effects to trace in the baseline.



BOTTLENECK	EFFECT ON TECHNICAL TEAMS	EVIDENCE TO CHECK
Unread / untriated work	The request reaches the technical team later, even before technical queueing begins.	Arrival → first touch; age of unowned cases.
Incomplete context	Engineers must ask for the service, evidence or prior history before investigation.	Needs-information returns; clarification touches.
Wrong or split ownership	Teams reassess or forward the request. A secondary issue may remain unowned.	Reassignment count; accepted owner; linked issues.
Urgency not made explicit	A time-sensitive issue can arrive without enough warning, disrupting planned work.	Impact/deadline captured; priority changes at handoff.
The improvement target is a faster, usable handoff, not simply more emails forwarded.		

Volume change: stakeholder account. Exception patterns: [S1]. Downstream effects are process hypotheses to test, not measured incidents.

Measure demand, human effort and handoff delay

Five measures are enough to establish the starting point without turning discovery into a reporting project.

3–5 min

Reported time for reading, classification and drafting in the source workflow.
Use as a reference; time routing, review and rework separately in the enterprise baseline.

METRIC	WORKING DEFINITION	READOUT
Inbound volume	Messages per business day, split into new requests and follow-up touches.	Daily count; pre/post-launch comparison.
Active handling time	Minutes actually spent reading, classifying, routing, drafting and reworking.	Minutes/message; total analyst hours/day.
Time to correct owner	Elapsed time from receipt to acceptance by the correct receiving team.	Median and P90; pending cases shown separately.
Intake backlog	Cases not yet replied to or accepted by an owner at the daily cutoff.	Open count and oldest age; waiting-for-info flagged.
Handoff rework	Handed-off cases returned for missing context or incorrect initial ownership.	% returned/reassigned, with reason and denominator.

3–5-minute reference: [S1], p. 1. Live daily volume, launch uplift and end-to-end timings are not supplied.

Keep baseline collection lightweight and traceable

Live-data capture plan: approved read-only records, a short time study and one shared check sheet.

01 Count the launch workload

Gmail metadata + Sheets / Excel

Compare 10 matched business days before and after launch where records exist. Keep inbound scope, timezone and working-day rules consistent.

Separate new requests from follow-ups; note staffing changes.

02 Time the manual work

Observed cases + timer + activity log

Start with 30–50 cases across busy and quieter periods. Include routine, multi-topic and follow-up work; report sample coverage.

Pause for interruptions. Tag clarification and rework separately.

03 Trace the handoff

Case ID + receiving-team acknowledgment

Link the original message to the handoff and the correct owner's acceptance. Use an agreed acknowledgment in the approved team tool.

A Slack post or ticket creation event alone is not acceptance.

04 Check the pattern

Sheets / Excel pivots + case review

Compare volume by day and time, handling effort by request type, and returns by reason. Review examples with the BA and technical owner.

Validate real patterns before drawing a volume or delay chart.

Methods: contextual observation [M2], check sheets [M3], stratification [M4] and Gmail message metadata [M5].

Use one case log and a separate activity log

The case log measures elapsed flow. The activity log measures actual human work.

CASE LOG / ONE ROW PER REQUEST

Identity	Case ID, message/thread link
Request	Type, priority, primary owner
Events	Received, first touch, sent, accepted
Outcome	Status, clarification or return reason

ACTIVITY LOG / ONE ROW PER TOUCH

Link	Case ID and person / role
Activity	Read, classify, route, draft or clarify
Timing	Start, stop and paused minutes
Rework	Flag and reason for repeat handling

Email timestamps tell me when a case moved. They do not tell me how long someone worked on it.

ACTIVE WORK

Sum of touch durations, minus pauses

INBOX WAIT

First touch minus received time

HANDOFF WAIT

Accepted time minus handoff sent time

Logging design developed for this section. Check-sheet method: [M3]. Field definitions and counting rules are in the PowerPoint notes.

Fix the delay that the baseline actually reveals

The goal is less analyst effort and a usable technical handoff, without moving the bottleneck downstream.

PATTERN IN THE BASELINE	NEXT ACTION
Unread queue is the main wait	Improve intake coverage and triage flow; check the BA's available capacity.
Reading and drafting dominate effort	Target repeatable classification and draft assistance, with human review.
Requests return for missing context	Improve required inputs, summaries and ownership rules before routing faster.
Correctly owned cases still wait	Review technical-team capacity and queue priorities. Intake automation alone will not fix this.

BASELINE HANDOFF PACKAGE

Current-state map

Request / owner map

Timed case log

Agreed metric definitions

Decision rules for interpreting the future baseline. These are not measured findings or achieved automation results.

Evidence and methods behind the analysis

Project facts, the source-workflow adaptation and the measurement plan are kept distinct.

PROJECT BASIS

Stakeholder account

The recent launch increased support-email volume and made manual analyst intake a bottleneck.

[S1] Prior email-assistant summary

Documents paper mapping, 25 reviewed tickets, request families and a 3–5-minute manual handling reference.

Current-state adaptation

The original onboarding-specialist role is mapped to the business analyst. Enterprise owners and handoff rules still need confirmation.

Baseline status

No mailbox counts or timed case log were supplied. Collection windows, sample sizes and metric definitions are the capture plan, not completed results.

METHODS & TOOLS

[\[M1\] draw.io | Swimlane diagrams](#)

Visualize roles and handoffs.

[\[M2\] GOV.UK | Contextual research](#)

Observe real tasks and workflow interruptions.

[\[M3\] ASQ | Check sheets](#)

Define repeatable, source-linked observations.

[\[M4\] ASQ | Stratification](#)

Separate request types, periods and conditions.

[\[M5\] Google | Gmail message metadata](#)

Message ID, thread ID and arrival timestamp.

Production access and the enterprise toolset remain subject to approval.